F – Changes to Executive Branch Management

Shall the City amend the Charter to expand the Mayor's authority to transfer responsibilities between departments, hire deputy mayors, and hire some and fire most department heads; and to allow City officials to remove members of boards and commissions without cause?

YES	◯
NO	◯

This measure requires 50%+1 affirmative votes to pass.

Digest by the Ballot Simplification Council

The Way It Is Now: The Mayor is the chief executive officer of the City. The Mayor directly supervises nearly 50 City departments, which are established by Charter or ordinance. Most City departments are established by Charter.

- Transfer of Functions: The Mayor can transfer responsibilities between departments established by ordinance, as long as the Board of Supervisors (Board) does not object. The Mayor cannot transfer responsibilities for departments established by the Charter.
- Deputy Mayors: The Mayor cannot hire deputy mayors to supervise most departments established by the Charter.
- Department Heads: In most cases, the Mayor must select a department head from candidates recommended by the board or commission that oversees that department. Usually, the board or commission can fire the department head, but the Mayor cannot.
- Commissioners: In addition to the Mayor, the Board and other officials appoint members to City boards and commissions. Appointed members can usually only be suspended or removed if the member engaged in official misconduct or committed certain felonies.

The Proposal: Proposition F would amend the Charter to allow the Mayor to do the following:

- Transfer of Functions: Transfer responsibilities between most departments or combine departments under a single department head, regardless of whether the Department was established by ordinance or Charter and as long as the Board does not object. The Mayor cannot eliminate any responsibilities established by Charter. The Mayor could also assign the oversight of these transferred responsibilities to that department's commission. The Mayor cannot transfer responsibilities of these departments:
  - City Administrator, Controller, Board of Appeals, Port, Airport, Asian Art Museum, Fine Arts Museums, San Francisco Municipal Transportation Agency, Public Utilities Commission, Civil Service Commission, Department of Human Resources, Retirement Board, Health Service System, Department of Elections, Ethics Commission, or departments headed by other elected officials.

  The responsibilities of the Department of Police Accountability cannot be transferred to the Police Department, and the responsibilities of the Sheriff's Inspector General cannot be transferred to the Sheriff.
- Deputy Mayors: Hire deputy mayors to supervise most departments established by the Charter.
- Department Heads: Hire some and fire most department heads without board or commission involvement. The Mayor cannot hire or fire certain department heads that are exempt (see *List of Exemptions* in Words You Need To Know).
- Commissioners: In addition to the Mayor, the Board and other officials who appoint board and commission members could remove them at any time without cause. This does not apply to the Board of Appeals, Civil Service Commission, or Ethics Commission. The Mayor cannot eliminate any board or commission established by the Charter.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of this measure. Arguments for and against this measure immediately follow.
The full text begins on page 201. Some of the words used in the ballot digest are explained starting on page 62.

A "YES" Vote Means: If you vote "yes," you want to expand the Mayor's authority to transfer responsibilities, hire deputy mayors, hire some and fire most department heads, and allow City officials to remove members of boards or commissions without cause.

A "NO" Vote Means: If you vote "no," you do not want to make these changes.

Controller's Statement on "F"

City Controller Greg Wagner has issued the following statement on the fiscal impact of Proposition F:

Should the proposed Charter amendment be approved by the voters, in my opinion, it would have a minimal impact on the cost of government, although at a level that cannot be determined at this time.

The proposed Charter amendment would (1) expand the Mayor's authority to hire and remove most departments heads; (2) allow most commissioners to be removed at will by their appointing authority; (3) authorize the Mayor to reorganize departments and adjust reporting relationships within the executive branch, subject to potential rejection by the Board of Supervisors; and (4) allow the use of deputy mayors.

The proposed Charter amendment authorizes the Mayor to utilize deputy mayors. The average annual cost for a deputy mayor would be approximately $250,000. The proposed Charter amendment allows the Mayor to restructure departments and reorient reporting relationships within the executive branch. The potential costs or savings incurred for such changes cannot be determined without knowing which departments would be involved and how the departments would be restructured. For example, in Fiscal Year 2022-23 when the Department of Sanitation and Streets merged into the Department of Public Works, the Controller's Office estimated cost savings of $3.5 million in the first year and $2.5 million in the second year of the merger. Cost savings came from removing duplicative administrative and information technology staff, departmental leadership, and one-time and ongoing costs, such as equipment and professional services.

How "F" Got on the Ballot

On July 23, 2026, the Department of Elections certified that the initiative petition calling for Proposition F to be placed on the ballot had a sufficient number of valid signatures to qualify the measure for the ballot.

53,076 signatures were required to place an initiative Charter Amendment on the ballot. This number is equal to 10% of the registered voters at the time a "Notice of Intent to Circulate Petition" was published. A random check of the signatures submitted by the proponents of the initiative petition prior to the July 6, 2026, submission deadline showed that the total number of valid signatures was greater than the number required.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of this measure. Arguments for and against this measure immediately follow.
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